

Lady -- Kenny Rogers

Kenny Rogers Greatest Hits, 1980. Written and produced by Lionel Richie. ~68 BPM.

Silky, soft, R&B-tinged ballad -- this is Lionel Richie soul-pop production, not a country song. The bass job is pure support: warm, smooth, out of the way of the strings and vocal.

GP-5 only, Sire fretless (Active -- the extra clarity keeps a low, silky part from disappearing under strings and keys), no pedalboard.

NAM: Darkglass Harmonic Booster

Darkglass Harmonic Booster -> Aguilar DB 751 amplifier -> Darkglass DG412ES cabinet -> Shure SM7B microphone. Slot 60.

This capture is the clean-voiced one of the Darkglass set -- no grit, no edge, just a warm, full clean tone. Exactly what a silky early-80s soul ballad wants.

AMP and CAB are off -- the NAM replaces both.

- Gain: 25 -- kept very low, no amp character beyond warmth. This part should sound almost DI-smooth.
- VOL: 65
- Bass: 58 -- full but not boomy.
- Middle: 50 -- neutral, doesn't fight the strings/keys sitting in the same range.
- Treble: 48 -- soft on top, no fretless string-noise brightness.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 20. Light -- this is a quiet part, just enough to clean up between-note noise without choking sustain.

PRE -- off. No boost anywhere. This tone doesn't need a push, it needs to stay smooth and even.

DST -- off. No drive, ever, on this one.

AMP / CAB -- off. Replaced by the NAM.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +2, 120Hz: 0, 400Hz: -3, 800Hz: 0, 4.5kHz: +2, VOL: 55.

A light low-end lift, a small scoop around 400Hz to keep things silky rather than boxy, and a gentle lift at 4.5kHz so the fretless still reads clearly under the strings.

MOD -- B-Chorus, always on, very light hand.

Depth: 12, Rate: 0.5Hz, VOL: 55.

Just enough shimmer to match the polished, slightly chorused feel of the production era -- barely perceptible as a discrete effect.

DLY -- off. No delay -- straightforward supportive part.

RVB -- Hall, on CTL.

Mix: 25, Decay: 45, Trail: true.

Off for the verses -- dry, close, intimate. On for the bridge/final chorus swell, giving the part a touch more air and size without turning it into a wash.

CTL footswitch

One module on CTL: RVB (Hall).

- **CTL off** -- verse/main sound. Dry, close, warm. Resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- bridge/final-chorus lift. Same clean NAM tone, just a touch of hall reverb added for size.

This song barely builds -- no need for a boost or gain-driven second state, just a subtle reverb lift for the one moment it opens up.